Hilal International Academy
MYP Assessment Policy

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HIA's Mission

To provide a progressive education that enables learners to attain their full potential as responsible, productive, creative and compassionate global citizens.

Core Values

1. **Professionalism** –The school shall serve stakeholders with the highest standards of professionalism and personal and collective excellence will be rewarded.
2. **Integrity** – The staff at the school shall at all times be trustworthy, faithful and honest in carrying out their duties and responsibilities. They shall be open to learning, receiving feedback and taking responsibility.
3. **Diversity** – The school shall affirm and celebrate diversity among the students, families and staff by encouraging genuine interactions between different peoples.
4. **Collaboration** – The school shall encourage and nurture collaboration and partnership among all stakeholders for the school to benefit from individual strengths.
5. **Ethical Value System**– The school community will seek to develop a sound ethical foundation of respecting human rights and freedoms, dignity and self-worth of every individual in the school.

HIA Vision

To be a safe learning environment in which pupils are empowered to seek, acquire and demonstrate knowledge, skills and values that will serve them and their communities in the future.

IB Mission

The International Baccalaureate® aims to develop inquiring, knowledgeable and caring young people who help to create a better and more peaceful world through intercultural understanding and respect.

To this end, the organization works with schools, governments and international organizations to develop challenging programmes of international education and rigorous assessment.

These programmes encourage students worldwide to become active, compassionate and lifelong learners who understand that other people, with their differences, can also be right.

IB Learner Profile

Our school values the cultivation of the whole learner, and as such, will assess students' achievements holistically. In addition to assessing specific learning outcomes, we will also evaluate the development of learners through the IB Learner Profile attributes of principled, risk-takers, knowledgeable, and inquirers.

Principled: We will assess the extent to which students demonstrate principled behaviour in their interactions with others, taking into account factors such as honesty, integrity, and responsibility.

Risk-takers: We will evaluate students' willingness to take risks and explore new perspectives, as well as their ability to learn from and reflect on these experiences.

Knowledgeable: We will assess the depth and breadth of students' knowledge across a range of subject areas, as well as their ability to apply this knowledge in real-world contexts.

Inquirers: We will evaluate the extent to which students have developed a love of learning and the ability to independently investigate and research new topics.

Statement of Philosophy

Student assessments are used at Hilal International Academy (HIA) to enhance learning for students and influence teaching. The HIA Preschool–12 curricula is completely interwoven with the continuous (formative and summative) assessment that demonstrates what students know and are capable of.

HIA MYP assessment policy is derived from the IBO assessment philosophy and principles, aligned across PYP and DP programmes. It is constructed around educational and pedagogical values and represents a statement of intent and action describing principles and practices for achieving educational goals relating to all aspects of assessment.

The goal of MYP assessment is to support and promote student learning; MYP assessment processes emphasize information gathering and analysis about student performance and timely feedback to students on their performance. MYP assessment plays a significant role in holistically developing students. In line with the MYP approach to assessment, HIA understands the significance of evaluating not only the products but also the processes.

Assessment is an essential component of all teaching and learning at HIA MYP, promoting student success. Teachers must evaluate students in accordance with MYP guidelines, using the set subject group objectives and assessment criteria for each subject group in each year of the program. Teachers must also give students the chance to perform at the highest level by developing challenging tasks that incorporate a range of assessment strategies.
Further, we believe that the assessment:

- Monitors the progress of student learning and achievement;
- Produces coherent feedback for students, teachers, parents and external institutions; and
- Informs instructional practice as well as curriculum and assessment in the school.

The school recognizes that students have:

- Different learning styles
- Different expectations, interests and academic potential
- Perform differently according to the context in which work is done and assessed
- Have a right to receive positive and informative feedback on their performance and progress

All assessments in the school should:

- Account for a variety of learning styles;
- Be differentiated to account for the diverse backgrounds of learners;
- Understand student's strengths and weaknesses and respond in ways that support their high achievement

- Provide a wide variety of different assessment opportunities and be relevant and motivating to students;
- Be criteria-related using published, agreed, learning objectives mandated by the IB and made clear to students by teachers before tasks begin;
- Measure what students understand, what they can do and what they know;
- Be both formative (to assist students in building understanding, skills and knowledge) and summative (to assess students' acquired understanding, skills and knowledge);
- Be ongoing and reflective;
- Allow students to evaluate their progress and set targets for improvement;
- Allow the school to evaluate the measure of success in meeting specific learning objectives;

- Be internally standardized both at departmental and grade levels to ensure consistency;
- Be geared toward an appraisal of a broad range of concepts, attitudes, knowledge and skills appropriate to an international and increasingly complex world.

Aims of the MYP Assessment

Assessment is the systematic collection of information about student learning and the use of that information to create a continuous cycle of improved teaching and learning. The primary goals as stated in "MYP: *From Principles into Practice"* (78) of the MYP assessment at HIA are:

- support and encourage student learning by providing feedback on the learning process
- inform, enhance and improve the teaching process
- provide the opportunity for students to exhibit transfer of skills across disciplines, such as in the personal project and interdisciplinary unit assessments
- promote positive student attitudes towards learning
- promote a deep understanding of subject content by supporting students in their inquiries set in real-world contexts
- promote the development of critical- and creative-thinking skills
- reflect the international-mindedness of the programme by allowing assessments to be set in a variety of cultural and linguistic contexts
- support the holistic nature of the programme by including in its model principles that take account of the development of the whole student.

Assessment Explanation

There are four objectives for each IB MYP subject group that have been developed by the IB and correlate to the standards by which the student's work will be evaluated. Instead of assessing the students' work to that of other students, the assessment standards will be displayed and discussed. This will make it easier for the learner to monitor his or her development and identify areas that require improvement.

Grading is based on the achievement levels attained for each criterion within numerical bands of 0-8 provided by IB. The achievement levels for the four criteria are based on the assessed summative work and the teacher's professional judgment. After having worked out the achievement levels for each criterion, these are added up to determine a semester grade for each subject.

HIA uses the IB MYP 1-7 grade scale to determine the semester grades in each year of the MYP. **The passing mark is 3 and above**.

MYP Internal and External Assessment

The MYP internal assessment consists of activities, strategies, and tools that have been created, refined, and used by teachers who interact with students at our school. These tests motivate instructors to keep track of their students' growing knowledge and skills over the course of the curriculum.

Purpose

Each unit includes formative and summative assessments that are planned at the beginning of the unit. All essential elements are assessed: knowledge, concepts, skills, service and action. Learners are informed of the purpose and means of assessment. To monitor the student's progress, reflect on teaching practices; use it for differentiation and to fill learning gaps.

Admission Assessment

The Admission Assessment at HIA is a process used to assess a student's readiness for the IB Middle Years Programme (MYP). It includes a written test, interview, and review of academic records and achievements. It is intended to help the admission team make informed decisions about student placement and support student success in the program.

Formative Assessment

Formative assessments are tools for learning, they are used on a daily basis within our school to measure what the student's knowledge and experience may be in order to know how to proceed with the lesson and the learning goal. Teachers will use a variety of assessment forms from verbal assessments to pre-tests in order to monitor student learning. Based on the results of the formative assessments, students, parents, and teachers can evaluate the student's learning and make the necessary adjustments.

Table 1. Tools and strategies in Formative assessment

Tools	**Strategies**
Anecdotal	Observations
Rubrics	Performance
Checklists	Process-focused assessment
Exemplars	Selected response (quizzes & tests)
Continuums	Open-ended tasks

Summative assessment

Summative assessments are retrospective; they are measures of learning that have taken place and are given at the end of a teaching unit or concept for the purpose of evaluating mastery. Teachers use a variety of assessment methods such as presentations, projects, portfolios, and paper tests in order to assess the level of mastery demonstrated by the student. The level of mastery is determined using a rubric for the assessment and the grade is recorded.

Assessing the Learner Profile Attributes

Purpose: At HIA, students are expected to model the learner profile attributes.

Learner profile will be assessed by students' self-reflections and meetings with teachers to set future goals.

Tools/ Strategies:

- Students will be introduced to a minimum of two learner profile attributes per unit, which will be reflected upon by the teachers.
- Students use different self-assessments and reflection sheets to show growth and understanding of the learner profile and it is kept in their portfolios. Teachers will reflect on the student's demonstration of the learner profile attributes in the report cards.
- All units of inquiry have focus attributes that are tackled throughout the unit and reflected upon by the students.
- Students will reflect on their understanding and personal growth of the learner profile attributes.

- Parents are invited to communicate any student action that reflects their growth of the learner profile attributes.

MYP Assessment Criteria and Achievement Levels

Teachers address goals in the MYP through classroom teaching and learning, which is the taught curriculum, as well as assessing criteria in the curriculum, which is the evaluated curriculum, through early and final assessment tasks.

Subject groups **must** assess **all** strands of all four assessment criteria **at least twice** in **each year** of the MYP.

IB provides the required assessment criteria for years 1, 3 and 5 of the MYP. At HIA, MYP teachers make decisions about students' achievement using their professional judgment and "best-fit" approach, guided by mandated criteria that are public, known in advance and precise (MYP Assessment Criteria are discussed with students in August and at the start of the unit), ensuring that assessment is transparent.

The MYP assessment criteria across subject groups

Table 2. The MYP assessment criteria across subject groups

	A	**B**	**C**	**D**
Language and literature	Analyzing	Organizing	Producing text	Using language
Language acquisition	Comprehending spoken and visual text	Comprehending written and visual text	Communicating	Using language
Individuals and societies	Knowing and understanding	Investigating	Communicating	Thinking Critically
Sciences	Knowing and understanding	Inquiring and designing	Processing and evaluating	Reflecting on the impacts of science
Mathematics	Knowing and understanding	Investigating patterns	Communicating	Applying mathematics in real-world contexts
Arts	Knowing and understanding	Developing skills	Thinking creatively	Responding
Physical and Health Education	Knowing and understanding	Planning for Performance	Applying and Performing	Reflecting and improving performance
Design	Inquiring and analyzing	Developing ideas	Creating the solution	Evaluating
MYP Project *	Investigating	Planning	Taking action	Reflecting
Interdisciplinary	Disciplinary grounding Synthesizing	Synthesizing	Communicating	Reflecting

Achievement levels

Each criterion has eight possible levels of achievement (0–8), divided into four bands that generally represent-

- the student doesn't reach a standard described by any of the descriptors following (0);
- limited (1–2);

- adequate (3–4);
- substantial (5–6); and
- excellent (7–8) performance.

Each band has its own unique descriptor. Teachers use the descriptors to make "best-fit" judgments about students' progress and achievement. The "best-fit" approach reflects the criterion-related philosophy of MYP assessment which does not require students to meet every strand of a criterion in order to be awarded a specific achievement level or progress to the next level. MYP assessment relies on teachers' professional judgment to develop and apply shared understandings of "what good looks like" (Further Guidance for Developing MYP Assessed Curriculum). Level 0 is available for work that is not described by the band descriptor for levels 1 and 2. Level 0 should not be used for missing work.

Missing Work

HIA works to provide marks that only reflect students' aptitude for the courses as determined by the IB MYP assessment processes' grading standards. We are aware of the necessity of ensuring that each student develops the IB Approaches To Learning abilities and IB Learner Profile traits, though. As a result, even though we think that students should have plenty of opportunities to turn in their work with personalized guidance, we also understand that there are times when they need to face consequences and disclose missing work. The expectation is that absent students will make up all lost assignments and exams when they return.

Below is the general process available to teachers at the end of grading periods where students have not submitted significant amounts of work, or heavily weighted assessments like projects, papers or exams:

Option 1: Teacher uses formative assessment results. This is a temporary condition and it is the student's responsibility to arrange a rehabilitation schedule with the teacher.

Option 2: The teacher uses a 0 as a placeholder, pending submission of student work. If a student submits the work within established time boundaries for the grading period, that assignment loses all late penalties; it is then assessed according to its academic merits, so the grade is changed. If the student chooses not to submit the work, the 0 remains and is used in order for the school system to calculate the semester/final grade.
There shall be an assessment timetable for the school in order to spread out tests and evaluations. The IB coordinators and deputy academics will be in charge of

this program so that they take into consideration internal and external assessment arrangements.

If a teacher suspects that a student is guilty of malpractice, he/she should not award a level of achievement and refer to the school's Academic Integrity Policy for further guidance. If a teacher, or another member of staff, suspects that a student may have breached the school's standards of academic honesty, he or she will inform the relevant IB Coordinator. The latter will investigate the matter and will inform the student of the concerns of the teacher, giving the student the chance to reply to the accusations. If it can be shown that inappropriate work has been submitted, the IB Coordinator will determine whether or not the case is one of academic dishonesty, or of academic infringement. Again in line with the IB's policy and practice, the determining difference between these two possibilities will be one of intent. In serious or contested circumstances, the Principal will decide the outcome of the case.

Teacher's responsibility

Teachers will give appropriate assessments taking into consideration the range of skills and types of assessment that the course envisages.

Students

Take all tests and evaluations as expected

If a test is missed it is the responsibility of the student to ensure that they inform the teacher at the earliest possible time. It should not be expected that the teacher will always organize a make-up test, their decisions will be guided by the reasons for missing the test in the first place.

Sometimes the student will miss a grade even when the work is marked-this happens so that the learning outcomes may be achieved even when the student is obviously in the wrong.

Homework is complementary to classroom teaching, and all students can expect to receive homework on a regular basis. Homework is intended to reinforce work covered in class and to help students develop important habits of self-discipline, organization and self-reliance. The amount of homework given will vary across the school; as a general rule, Grades 1-7 can expect 1 to 3 hours of homework in a week, Grades 8, 8-10 hours and Grades 10 and 11 can expect up to 15 hours of additional home research and study per week.

In line with our policy of fostering independent learning and striving to develop the dispositions of the IB Learner Profile, we promote a collaborative approach to the setting of homework, through which teachers will plan homework schedules at regular curriculum planning meetings and will, as appropriate, involve students in the setting of deadlines. Students are responsible for organizing their time appropriately to manage long-term projects. Teachers expect homework to be done properly and punctually. Failure to do homework is treated seriously, and when completing homework is perceived to be problematic, the teacher will notify the student's class teacher and the relevant Head of Grade, who may require the student to forfeit his/her break time to complete the outstanding work or be asked to attend homework club. Parents will be notified should a student repeatedly fail to submit school work.

Recording and Reporting Student Achievement

Through [system] Gradebook, MYP Portfolios, and report cards, HIA updates parents on student success in each subject area on a monthly basis throughout the five years of the MYP. The student's degree of success for each assessment criterion for each subject group is reported in MYP reports. This procedure informs students and their parents about how well the students are meeting the goals of each subject group area and, when necessary, offers suggestions for development.

MYP Grades and Grade Descriptors

"No surprises" is the HIA's operating philosophy. When a student's grades fall below a grade 4 at any point during the term, teachers are required to notify parents, the MYP Coordinator, and the Deputy Academics. Teachers add up the achievement levels (0–8) for all four categories for all summative assignments to decide the semester score. Each year of the MYP, HIA calculates the semester/final mark on a scale of 1–7 using the grade boundary rules. The IB defines grade 3 and above as the passing score. The performance level summaries are converted into grades on a range of 1–7 in Table 3 along with grade descriptors.

Table 3. MYP General Grade Descriptors

Grade	Boundary guidelines (achievement level totals)	Descriptor
1	**1-5**	Produces work of very limited quality. Conveys many significant misunderstandings or lacks understanding of most concepts and contexts. Very rarely demonstrates critical or creative thinking. Very inflexible, rarely using knowledge or skills
2	**6-9**	Produces work of limited quality. Expresses misunderstandings or significant gaps in understanding for many concepts and contexts. Infrequently demonstrates critical or creative thinking. Generally inflexible in the use of knowledge and skills, infrequently applying knowledge and skills.
3	**10-14**	Produces work of acceptable quality. Communicates basic understanding of many concepts and contexts, with occasionally significant misunderstandings or gaps. Begins to demonstrate some basic critical and creative thinking. Is often inflexible in the use of knowledge and skills, requiring support even in familiar classroom situations.
4	**15-18**	Produces good-quality work. Communicates a basic understanding of most concepts and contexts with few misunderstandings and minor gaps. Often demonstrates basic critical and creative thinking. Uses knowledge and skills with some flexibility in familiar classroom situations but requires support in unfamiliar situations.
5	**19-23**	Produces generally high-quality work. Communicates a secure understanding of concepts and contexts. Demonstrates critical and creative thinking, sometimes with sophistication. Uses knowledge and skills in the familiar classroom and real-world situations and, with support, some unfamiliar real-world situations.
6	**24-27**	Produces high-quality, occasionally innovative work. Communicates an extensive understanding of concepts and contexts. Demonstrates critical and creative thinking, frequently with sophistication. Uses knowledge and skills in familiar and unfamiliar classrooms and real-world situations, often with independence.
7	**28-32**	Produces high-quality, frequently innovative work. Communicates a comprehensive, nuanced understanding of concepts and contexts. Consistently demonstrates sophisticated critical and creative thinking. Frequently transfers knowledge and skills with independence and expertise in a variety of complex classroom and real-world situations.

Internal standardization

The HIA MYP internal standardization processes paper serves as a guide for internal standardization (Appendix 1). Teachers get together to discuss the standards and degrees of success for student work as part of the internal uniformity of evaluation. Teachers improve the accuracy of their conclusions by doing this.

Subject groups

Standardization within subject groups promotes consistency and builds common understandings about student achievement with respect to MYP objectives/assessment criteria. In general, subject groups consist of 1-3 educators teaching at different year levels. The following practices are employed for internal standardization.

- Peer review of year-level summative assessment tasks within the subject group.
- Using interdisciplinary unit assessments for internal standardization.
- My IB Programme Resource Center subject-specific Teacher support materials provide examples of assessed student work to guide the assessment. Analyzing the examples individually and within the subject group.
- My IB Programme Resource Center "Specimen marked candidate responses" provides examples of student responses in eAssessment subjects. These responses may be used to inform individual teacher markings and discussed in subject groups.

Personal project

External moderation of the personal project is mandatory. Prior to the external moderation, as required by the IB “Schools ensure that the projects are assessed and internally standardized by the supervisors in the school according to the criteria stated in Projects guide” (MYP Projects guide 10), each project goes through the following internal standardization procedures:

- Initial assessment (supervisor);
- Assessment by another 2 arbitrarily assigned supervisors. An additional MYP teacher may be added to the group;
- Group discussion/agreement upon the final level of achievement (supervisor, MYP teachers);

- Standardized achievement level and grade with a comment issued to the MYP Coordinator to enter into IBIS, to the student, and recorded to ManageBac Projects assessment section (supervisor).

Final Year of the Programme: MYP 5

At the end of the MYP programme, in year 5, students receive the MYP final grade for each subject group, and for the personal project.

It is required that the personal project be moderated for institutions finishing in MYP year 5. The MYP 5 students who are HIA MYP Course Candidates have their projects publicly reviewed by IB assessors in exchange for IB MYP course results and a mark (1-7) for the Personal project.

When the MYP program in year 5 comes to a close, the personal project is an accumulated learning experience. It represents the student's total MYP experience and is the result of his or her own effort. It gives students the chance to conduct research on an interest of theirs, produce a creative work of their choosing (PRODUCT/OUTCOME), and analyze the project's execution (PROJECT REPORT) in order to demonstrate their newly acquired knowledge, their growth in learning strategies, and their comprehension of concepts related to the global context.

Optional eAssessment for MYP Year 5 Candidates

(Currently not offered at HIA)

MYP eAssessment is an optional service for IB World Schools that results in IB-validated grades recorded as MYP course results, which can contribute to the award of the MYP certificate. The following possibilities are available for MYP Year 5 students:

The MYP Certificate is the highest award for the MYP and results in certification by the IB Organization. Specific requirements have to be met. (General regulations: Middle Years Programme 7-8).

The main MYP awards record is the MYP Course Results. It lists every subject the candidate has studied and the score they received. (1–7). Additionally, it demonstrates that the community service obligation set forth by the school, as well as the score received for the personal project and interdisciplinary evaluation, were satisfied. The outcomes record only demonstrates success.

MYP learners who have been enrolled in the program for at least two years and finished the prerequisites in year 3 or year 4 are eligible for the **MYP Record of Participation**. These pupils are not signed up for any kind of evaluation through the IB. The school-based Record of Participation is a record that is given by the school and is not validated by the IB Organization. Certain conditions must be satisfied. (General regulations: Middle Years Programme 8).

Recognition of the MYP Certificate

The IB actively promotes wide recognition and acceptance of the MYP Certificate or MYP Course Results as a basis for continuing education but does not guarantee recognition of the MYP Certificate or MYP Course Results by any institution or relevant authority in a country. Consequently, candidates and legal guardians bear the sole responsibility for verifying whether the MYP Certificate or MYP Course Results have recognition and acceptance.

When a candidate has assessment access needs, inclusive assessment plans are modified or subject to extra requirements. These are not meant to make up for any skill gaps; rather, they help the candidate more equitably show his or her degree of attainment. As stated in "General regulations: Middle Years Programme" pg. 10-11 and "Candidates with assessment access requirements (Middle Years Programme)," HIA will adhere to the IB MYP learning assistance standards for electronic assessments.

Policy Alignment

HIA MYP assessment philosophy and policy align with ISE school values and other policies as outlined below. In all of these policies and procedures, the student is central.

The IB Learner

Profile states that students are reflective meaning analyzes their own strength and weaknesses through formative self, peer and teacher, as well as the formal summative assessment for success.

HIA mission statement

Our mission statement aims “To provide a progressive education that enables learners to attain their full potential as responsible, productive, creative and compassionate global citizens.”. Part of being responsible, productive, creative

and compassionate is understanding and demonstrating integrity and honesty in all learning assignments and tasks as a student and an individual.

HIA MYP academic honesty policy

HIA MYP assessment policy aligns with our academic honesty policy.

Policy review

Policies will be revised at the beginning of each school academic year by the respective Programme teachers. A review process including student and parent representatives will be taken after every three years.

Last reviewed March 20, 2023.

Appendices

Appendix 1: HIA Internal Standardization Procedures Follow this link to HIA Internal Standardization Procedures document.

Appendix 4: HIA MYP Academic Honesty Policy Follow this link to HIA Academic Honesty Policy

Sources

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